

V Teamers

Performance toolkit



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What's in this toolkit?

In this toolkit you will find information on navigating the performance process, support for goal setting, and tips for having performance conversations.

It will answer questions such as:

- How do I set goals with my manager?
- What are the annual performance processes and how can I prepare?
- How do I have a performance conversation and prepare to receive feedback from my manager?

Use this toolkit to help maximize your performance and achieve your goals!

Need something else?

Check out these other helpful resources:

- [My Career](#)
- [My Performance Page](#)
- [My Development Page](#)
- [Development Toolkit](#)
- [V Team Central Performance Review Job Aid](#)

What is performance management



What is performance management?

At Verizon, we view performance management as all of the practices and processes that **recognize, reward, and reinforce** the **behaviors, impacts,** and **outcomes** that drive **culture, innovation,** and **growth.**

It is a **partnership and shared responsibility** for V Teamers and their managers to set goals, align priorities, engage in continuous feedback, and steer development.

Performance management is meant to be **forward-focused, inspiring, and motivating** to help you meet and achieve your goals.



Performance throughout the year

Goal Setting: Collaborate with your manager to set and discuss SMART goals at the beginning of the year or when you're new in role.

Mid-Year Review: Discuss performance from the first half of the year and update performance goals and development actions for the second half.

Year-End Review: Discuss your performance against your performance goals and discuss expectations for the new year.

Continuous Conversations: Throughout the year, have ongoing conversations about performance and development, and how you are making progress towards your goals. You can use the 2+2 model! Learn more about 2+2s [here](#).



Who is involved in the performance process



You

You are responsible for collaborating to create your goals, keeping your goals up to date, and recording your accomplishments against your goals. You should also remember to check in regularly with your manager and ask for coaching and feedback. Use this feedback to help you continuously improve.

Your manager

Your manager is responsible for collaborating to create your goals, providing continuous feedback throughout the year, and evaluating your performance at Mid-Year and Year-End.

Your HR Partner

Your HR Business Partner can help you navigate the process and provide you support when and if you need it.

Goal setting

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Setting performance goals

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4



Setting clear goals with your manager at the beginning of the year (or when you start a new role) ensures that you know what is expected and how your work contributes to the team. When creating or updating your performance goals, make sure each goal is specific and describes what results are expected, by when, and how results will be measured.

Goal examples:

- Address all customer escalations within 24 hours with a 98% customer satisfaction rating.
- Implement system upgrade by the end of the 2nd quarter and within budget.
- Achieve billing error reduction of at least 25-30% by year-end.

When you and your manager discuss your goals make sure you...

- Are clear on your performance goals and know what is expected. When in doubt, ask.
- Understand how your goals are aligned with team goals and business priorities.
- Ask for the resources and support you need to achieve your goals.

SMART goals

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

Creating strong performance goals is the key to unlocking your potential. When you start the year, a new project, or a new role with clear expectations, plan for the support you will need to accomplish your goals.

How do you set strong goals? The first step is to think SMART. You've likely heard this before but it bears repeating.

Specific	Clearly defines the results that should be accomplished.
Measurable	Gauges progress and success using quantitative or qualitative measures.
Achievable	Ensures goal is doable within the set timeframe.
Relevant	Ensures the goal supports progress towards team goals and objectives of the business.
Time Bound	Will be accomplished within a specific time frame.

Updating goals throughout the year

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4



Performance goals are not set in stone!

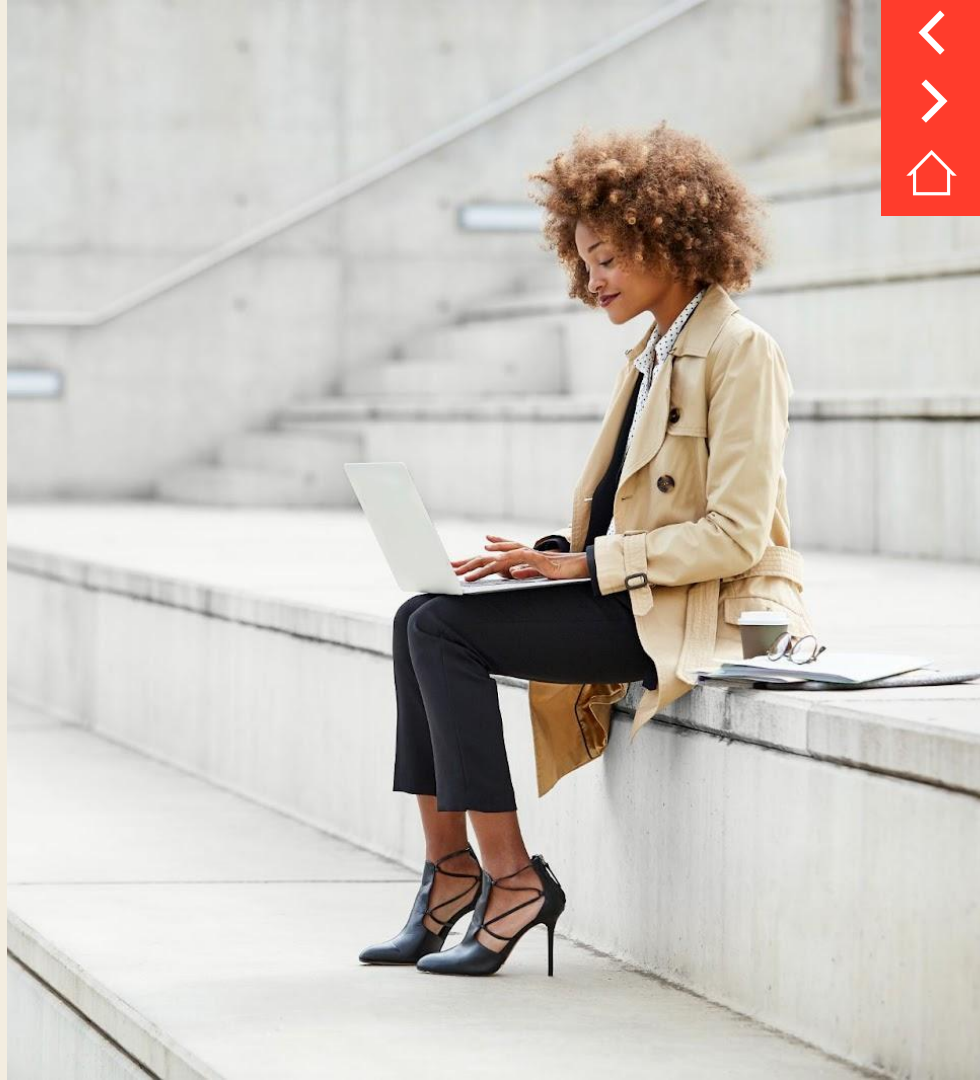
Business needs change and evolve over the year and so should your goals. As you continue to have performance conversations throughout the year make sure your written goals still align with your discussions.

- Did a project get delayed that caused you to shift your priorities elsewhere?
- Did you pick up a workstream for a colleague who was promoted?
- Are you realizing that what was initially a side project is becoming more critical for the team?

Make sure the milestones you are working towards are reflected in your Performance Goals by setting aside time regularly to check in.

Remember to discuss any proposed changes with your manager before updating.

Writing performance accomplishments



Reflecting on your accomplishments

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

Writing your accomplishments helps you reflect on and communicate your contributions to the team and to the business. Think about what you achieved and highlight how you accomplished your goals. Highlight significant successes and recognition you received.

When gathering your accomplishments, think about both quantitative and qualitative factors including:

Your **core** performance against goals and expectations, **how** you demonstrated our values, teamwork and V Team Principles, the **impact** of your accomplishments to the business and other contributions above and beyond the your primary role and/responsibilities including additional or stretch assignments.



Things to consider:

Reflect on your achievements from the full year: What specific outcomes did you achieve? Quantify where possible.

Consider *how* you are meeting expectations including:

- V Team Principles
- Our values as part of Culture OS

What were the results compared to measures, such as quantity, cost savings, budget, time?

Did you overcome any challenges to achieve your goals?

How did your results support team goals and priorities?

How did I demonstrate our values and V Team Principles in my accomplishments?

As you enter your accomplishments, include examples of how you demonstrated our values and [V Team Principles](#)

Demonstrating our values and the V Team Principles in your day-to-day actions

Your performance at work is not only about what you do but about how you get things done. Describe how you demonstrated our values and V Team Principles every day. **Example:** Ran to a crisis by supporting the Southeast region after a hurricane to quickly restore the network.

Beyond your daily responsibilities, think about other ways that you have demonstrated our values. **Attach an additional sheet to your review** with these items in the attachments section. Some examples could include:

Employee Resource Group (ERG) accomplishments

Note your accomplishments with details of the impact including V Team Principles demonstrated and skills that you may have developed. Click [HERE](#) for a template to help you craft your accomplishments.

Example: Developed a mentoring program within ERGs connecting executives with participants to provide insight into their career goals and actionable steps to achieve those goals. Ten employees successfully completed the program which was rated favorably as a valuable step in their development.

Accomplishments from Verizon groups

ex. Verizon Green Team

Use your participation in group/ team activities to demonstrate your skills and achievements in the context of our values. What did you help Verizon achieve by participating? How did you help move the world forward together?

Example: Demonstrated commitment to our corporate values and social responsibility by collaborating in the creation of a Green Team Learning Portal Pathway resulting in over 300 completions.

Sample accomplishments



Goal: Implement a new protocol for job inspections by Q2.

Accomplishment: Developed a comprehensive approach to conducting job inspections that contributed to the team's reduction of safety incidents by 5%.

Goal: Complete a profit-loss analysis by February 1st.

Accomplishment: Completed detailed profit-and-loss analyses ahead of the deadline. Improved the accuracy of the estimates which provided my leadership with more reliable data for strategic planning.

Goal: Drive teamwork by organizing and leading the team in a development activity in the second quarter.

Accomplishment: I demonstrated our values and the V Team Principle of Activate Teamwork by leading a development session focused on team strengths and how to best partner and leverage each other's strengths daily.

For more questions to help you reflect on your accomplishments check out the additional examples [here](#)!

Tracking your accomplishments throughout the year

Q1

Q2

Q3

Q4

We've all faced the inevitable anxiety when putting together our accomplishments before a review "I can't remember what I've accomplished!" To avoid the stress, use these tips to keep track throughout the year!

Track your progress right from your goal in V Team Central!

Open up your goal from your profile and leave a comment in the activity workstream. You can even access these from your review at mid-year and year-end! Check out the [Goals Job Aid](#) for more info.



Post



Use slack reminders to prompt you to record your accomplishments on a weekly, monthly, or quarterly basis.

Type /remind in a slack message to yourself. Add the reminder and frequency.

Example: /remind me to record my performance accomplishments every month



Use calendar reminders to prompt you to record accomplishments or check-in with your leader.

Example: Add a recurring event for 30 minutes on the last Friday of each month to record progress and accomplishments. Add a link to your Performance Goals for easy access!

2+2 conversations are also be a great place to keep track of your progress towards Performance Goals.

Performance reviews

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What to expect



Your manager will write a Performance Summary that includes observations from the full performance period (the first half of the year during the Mid Year period and the full year during the Year End period).

In this written review you can expect to find things like:

- **Your results** compared to goals and, at year-end, a rating representing those results.
- **Your accomplishments** and what you did well.
- What can be done **better**, and how those things can be improved.
- What you should **focus** on moving forward.
- A review of how you **achieved your goals**:
 - Behaviors that demonstrated our values. For example, references to Employee Resource Group (ERG) accomplishments.
 - How you brought the V Team Principles to life.

Performance ratings at year end



Top Performing

Exceeding

Achieving

Approaching

Needs Improvement

In response to your valuable feedback, we are transitioning to a **5-point performance rating scale** from the previous 3-point scale.

This change is designed to better serve V Teamers, offering a more flexible approach to performance reviews with **clearer and more detailed feedback** to help you **drive your performance and career!**

Learn more about the new ratings on the next page >

The 5 point rating scale

5-Point Performance Rating Scale

Top Performing	Far exceeds all goals, requirements and expectations; Strongest contributions and impact in the organization.
Exceeding	Exceeds all or most goals, requirements and expectations
Achieving	Meets all goals, requirements and expectations and periodically exceeds some
Approaching	Meets some goals, requirements and expectations, but has opportunity to improve on one or more goals
Needs Improvement	Not meeting most goals, requirements and expectations; Significant improvement is needed

Why shift to a 5-point scale?

- 1. Provides even greater transparency**
- 2. Encourages higher quality feedback**
- 3. Enables more effective recognition and support**

And- we heard you! We're taking your feedback to support your Journey Forward and drive your performance and career!

Performance conversations

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Before



Prepare!

Review your performance goals and think about what you've accomplished towards each one and how you've achieved your goals. Use these questions and the [worksheet](#) on the next page to plan for the conversation.

Things to consider

What results have I achieved? What have I done well?

What is the accomplishment(s) I am most proud of?

What are my opportunities to improve and develop?

How have I modeled our values and V Team Principles?

Did I overcome any challenges to achieve my goals?

What should I start, stop and continue?

What could I have done better or differently?

What support do I need from my manager?

Before	Notes
What results have I achieved?	
What have I done well?	
What challenges did I overcome?	
What accomplishment am I most proud of?	
How have I modeled the V Team principles?	
What should I start stop and continue?	
What could I have done better or differently?	
What are my opportunities to improve and develop?	
What support do I need from my manager?	

Make a copy

During



A performance conversation is a two-way dialogue with your manager so keep in mind the following tips.

- Share your accomplishments and how you've contributed to the team and business results.
- Ask for your manager's perspective.
- Be open and listen carefully.
- Ask questions for clarification.
- Align on action items and any support needed.

When having a virtual conversation

- Turn your camera on; it's more personal and engaging.
- Arrange to be in a quiet, private space.
- If a disruption does occur, request to schedule additional time to continue the conversation.

After

1

Update your performance goals and development actions in the system.

2

Take one action based on what you and your manager discussed.

3

Schedule the next 2+2 conversation with your manager.



4

Start a list or create a space where you can record questions and roadblocks.

5

Set reminders to ask for frequent feedback on your progress.

6

Align on changes in priorities and make updates as needed.

Have a 2+2

These are moments that matter!

2+2 Template

Start 2+2

2+2 Conversations are opportunities to step back from your day-to-day work and have a conversation about your progress towards performance and development goals.

In a 2+2, your manager will share:

- **two** comments on progress towards performance or development goals and
- **two** items you should do more or less of to increase performance or advance development moving forward.

Download a template to help you prep or start your 2+2!

- Be intentional about creating these moments. Partner with your manager to set recurring meetings for these conversations.
- Make sure your 2+2s do not turn into 1:1 conversations. Try to avoid talking about day-to-day responsibilities and focus more on the big picture.
- No need to wait for a 2+2! Ask for timely, actionable and constructive feedback as close to “in the moment” as possible.
- Prepare for your 2+2 by reflecting on progress you have made towards your goals and where you want to focus moving forward

